# Thanksgiving Turkey Thaw Dates, Nov. 26, 2026

When to move a frozen turkey to the refrigerator

| START THAWING | TURKEY WEIGHT AND METHOD | DONE |
|---|---|---|
| **Fri., Nov. 20 to Sat., Nov. 21** | 20 to 24 lb turkey, refrigerator (5 to 6 days) | ☐ |
| **Sat., Nov. 21 to Sun., Nov. 22** | 16 to 20 lb turkey, refrigerator (4 to 5 days) | ☐ |
| **Sun., Nov. 22 to Mon., Nov. 23** | 12 to 16 lb turkey, refrigerator (3 to 4 days) | ☐ |
| **Mon., Nov. 23 to Wed., Nov. 25** | 4 to 12 lb turkey, refrigerator (1 to 3 days) | ☐ |
| **Thu., Nov. 26** | Cook to 165°F (74°C); cold-water thaw only if still frozen | ☐ |

## My notes

Source: USDA Food Safety and Inspection Service, Turkey Basics: Safe Thawing; CDC, Preparing Your Holiday Turkey Safely. Dates are planning estimates, not guarantees.